

FEEL THE ENERGY

A waterwheel is an "energy-transfer device." Like anything that moves, flowing water possesses a form of energy called kinetic energy. Your waterwheel will capture some of that energy and begin turning. A string wrapped around the shaft of your waterwheel can lift a weight. As the weight lifts higher up, it gains potential energy (it has the "potential" to fall down again), also called stored energy.



WATERWHEEL

Question: How can you lift a weight just by turning on a faucet or pouring water from a glass? Answer: With a waterwheel, of course. Waterwheels have been used to extract energy from flowing water for many hundreds of years—to grind corn, power machinery, or lift heavy objects. You can make your own waterwheel from a plastic bottle, a straw, and a wooden skewer. It'll create quite a splash!

The waterwheel lifts a weight made of adhesive putty.